

Savannah Balistreri

savannahbsf@gmail.com | 415-595-4633 | www.linkedin.com/in/savannah-b-3350a6239 | San Francisco, CA
<https://thebestplant.github.io/portfolio/>

Summary

Gameplay Programmer and Game Design & Development graduate student with a strong foundation in C++, mathematics, and real-time game engine workflows. Currently pursuing an M.S. in Game Design & Development at RIT. Experienced in Unreal Engine and Unity gameplay systems, debugging, rapid prototyping, and collaborating across disciplines. Passionate about building polished gameplay features and learning advanced engine tools.

Technical Skills

Programming & Tools: Unreal Engine, Unity, C++, C#, Python, Java, GitHub, Construct 3

Game Development: Gameplay Programming, Debugging, Version Control, Rapid Prototyping

Project Management: Agile (Scrum), Sprint Planning & Retrospectives, Backlog Management, Task Prioritization, Trello, Cross-functional Collaboration, Milestone Tracking, Team Leadership

Projects

InterLinked - Tech Lead

Jan. 2026 - Present

- Utilized Trello and Agile to manage three developers
- Implemented gameplay mechanics in Unreal Engine 5
- Developed visual effects using the Niagara system
- Integrated 3D assets created by cross-functional team members

Experience

Fellowship Counselor - Girls Make Games

May 2024 - Jul. 2025

- Produced and programmed for young artists and designers
- Taught girls (ages 11 to 15) how to use Unity
- Programmed multiple games in 2 week periods
- Won the Demo Day competition, game shown at The Game Awards 2025

Marketing Intern - ADD Systems

Jul. 2023 - Sep. 2024

- Focused on automation, data analysis, & image creation
- Utilized HubSpot to work with contacts, create automated workflows, & analyze data
- Worked with Excel to generate informative reports

Grader - Santa Clara University

Apr. 2024 - Jun. 2024

- Recommended by professor to grade coursework for Theory of Automata & Languages

Peer Educator - Santa Clara University

Sep. 2023 - Dec. 2023

- Chosen due to exceptional performance in Linear Algebra

Education

Rochester Institute of Technology - M.S. Game Design & Development

Aug. 2025 - Present, expected graduation May 2027

Santa Clara University - B.S. Computer Science; Minors in Studio Art & Creative Writing

Sep. 2021 - Jun. 2025